

“A little bit...”

What is the “Way of the Cross”?

The Orthodox Christian faith is full of life-giving truth, but it is also very complex and even overwhelming to beginners. It is not at all like the typical Western expression of Christianity, and this is part of the reason why it is so overwhelming and seems too big to many people. These small postings are in attempt to give “A Little Bit” of knowledge and edification regarding Orthodox Christianity. Since they come from my mind, they are not necessarily organized, but they are absolutely from the heart. It may be very hard to learn all the fasting rules and to go to long services and to read the Fathers, or even the Bible, but it is not so hard to read or listen to or watch a short video about something that is just “A Little Bit” about Christianity. [Priest Seraphim Holland](#), who is learning a little bit each day about how to be a real Christian.



Raising our Old Rugged Cross in 2012, after we built our new church and decided the cross should be at the front, before our entrance, and prostrating before it, Sunday of the Cross, Great Lent, 2018. We think [+Daniel](#) was not prostrating with us but rejoicing.

The Gospel talks a lot about the “Taking up of the Cross” and we have come to call the life we lead after doing this the “Way of the Cross”. Perhaps the Scripture is a little hard to understand for some, so let’s put it in very simple terms – the heart will understand.

What is the Way of the Cross? For the answer, we look to the earthly life of our Lord. It is voluntary obedience to God because of love.

All of Christian life is voluntary, and all of it is because of love. Our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ’s earthly ministry is the best example of love. If you measure your thoughts, attitudes, priorities and actions based on this understanding of the “Way of the Cross”, you will not be far from the Kingdom of Heaven.

Please read the Scriptures about the way of the cross below and “decode” them looking for these things: we are asked to make a voluntary decision, we are asked to follow Christ, which is to evaluate everything based on love. The “Way of the Cross” therefore is voluntary and is to follow our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ example in everything we do.

Matthew 16:24 Then said Jesus unto his disciples, If any *man* will come after me, let him deny himself, and take up his cross, and follow me.

Mark 8:34 And when he had called the people *unto him* with his disciples also, he said unto them, Whosoever will come after me, let him deny himself, and take up his cross, and follow me.

Mark 10:21 Then Jesus beholding him loved him, and said unto him, One thing thou lackest: go thy way, sell whatsoever thou hast, and give to the poor, and thou shalt have treasure in heaven: and come, take up the cross, and follow me.

Luke 9:23 And he said to *them* all, If any *man* will come after me, let him deny himself, and take up his cross daily, and follow me.

This has been just “a little bit” about the “Way of the Cross”. 3/22/2018

<http://www.orthodox.net/a-little-bit/alb-what-is-the-way-of-the-cross.pdf> <http://www.orthodox.net/a-little-bit/alb-what-is-the-way-of-the-cross.doc>

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